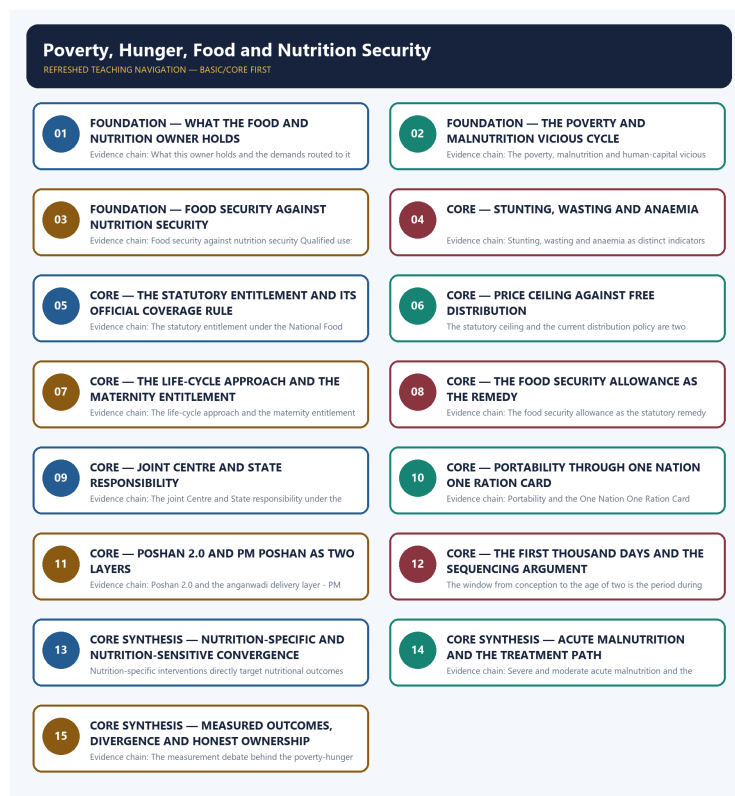


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Poverty, Hunger, Food and Nutrition Security - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Poverty, Hunger, Food and Nutrition Security - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this owner holds and the demands routed to it?

A. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. B. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. C. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. D. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: A. Explanation: This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under What this owner holds and the demands routed to it?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic

argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. D. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: B. Explanation: This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this owner holds and the demands routed to it?

A. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. B. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: C. Explanation: This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues

entitlement, access and conversion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this owner holds and the demands routed to it?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. C. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. D. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.

Answer: D. Explanation: This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle?

A. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. B. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the

examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. C. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: A. Explanation: The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle?

A. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. B. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. C. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: B. Explanation: The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from

impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. C. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. D. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.

Answer: C. Explanation: The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The poverty, malnutrition and human-capital vicious cycle?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. The Act itself fixes

Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for.

Answer: D. Explanation: The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Food security against nutrition security?

A. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. B. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. C. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.

Answer: A. Explanation: Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and

grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Food security against nutrition security?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. C. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. D. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.

Answer: B. Explanation: Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Food security against nutrition security?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. The Act itself fixes

Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. C. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. D. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

Answer: C. Explanation: Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Food security against nutrition security?

A. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. D. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

Answer: D. Explanation: Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and

grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators?

A. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. B. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. C. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: A. Explanation: Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators?

A. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. B. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and

reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.

Answer: B. Explanation: Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

Answer: C. Explanation: Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Stunting, wasting and anaemia as distinct indicators?

A. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: D. Explanation: Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has

been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. C. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. D. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States

and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013?

A. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The statutory entitlement under the National Food Security Act, 2013?

A. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. B. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. C. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy?

A. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. B. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. C. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint

responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. D. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy?

A. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. B. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. C. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household

beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy?

A. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Central Issue Price ceiling against the free-distribution policy?

A. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. B. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and

the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. C. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. D. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act?

A. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious

meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act?

A. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. B. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. C. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act?

A. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. C. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The life-cycle approach and the maternity entitlement in the Act?

A. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. B. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during

which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The food security allowance as the statutory remedy?

A. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: A. Explanation: The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what

allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under The food security allowance as the statutory remedy?

A. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. B. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. C. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. D. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.

Answer: B. Explanation: The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The food security allowance as the statutory remedy?

A. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. B. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. C. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is

what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. D. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.

Answer: C. Explanation: The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The food security allowance as the statutory remedy?

A. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. B. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

Answer: D. Explanation: The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act?

A. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. B. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. C. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: A. Explanation: The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act?

A. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. B. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as

child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: B. Explanation: The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act?

A. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. B. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. C. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. D. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

Answer: C. Explanation: The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The joint Centre and State responsibility under the Act?

A. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. B. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

Answer: D. Explanation: The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism?

A. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. B. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as

take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: A. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism?

A. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. C. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. D. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

Answer: B. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. C. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. D. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

Answer: C. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Portability and the One Nation One Ration Card mechanism?

A. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. B. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. C. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a

separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.

Answer: D. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer?

A. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. B. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. C. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. D. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.

Answer: A. Explanation: Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.

Answer: B. Explanation: Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. C. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. D. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment

where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

Answer: C. Explanation: Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi delivery layer?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. D. Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.

Answer: D. Explanation: Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer?

A. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. B. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. C. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. D. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

Answer: A. Explanation: PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer?

A. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. B. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. C. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. D. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather

than merely listing it.

Answer: B. Explanation: PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. D. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

Answer: C. Explanation: PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about PM POSHAN and the school nutrition layer?

A. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. B. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. C. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. D. PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.

Answer: D. Explanation: PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The first thousand days as the critical window?

A. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. B. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. C. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. D. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based

supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

Answer: A. Explanation: The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under The first thousand days as the critical window?

A. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. B. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. C. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. D. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it.

Answer: B. Explanation: The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The first thousand days as the critical window?

A. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition

rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: C. Explanation: The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The first thousand days as the critical window?

A. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukht Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. B. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. C. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. D. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

Answer: D. Explanation: The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as

child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions?

A. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. D. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

Answer: A. Explanation: Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions?

A. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. B. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. C. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh

households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: B. Explanation: Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions?

A. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. B. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. C. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: C. Explanation: Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nutrition-specific against nutrition-sensitive interventions?

A. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukht Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. B. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. C. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. D. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.

Answer: D. Explanation: Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal?

A. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. D. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the

primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

Answer: A. Explanation: A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal?

A. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. B. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukt Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: B. Explanation: A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal?

A. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukht Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. B. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. C. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Answer: C. Explanation: A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Take-home ration against the hot cooked meal?

A. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation

One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukht Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it.

Answer: D. Explanation: A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path?

A. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. B. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukht Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: A. Explanation: Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path?

A. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. B. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. C. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. D. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.

Answer: B. Explanation: Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path?

A. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. B. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. C. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is

severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. D. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.

Answer: C. Explanation: Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Severe and moderate acute malnutrition and the treatment path?

A. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. D. Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

Answer: D. Explanation: Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Measured outcomes with their survey round attached?

A. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. B. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Measured outcomes with their survey round attached?

A. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. B. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered

through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Measured outcomes with their survey round attached?

A. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or

policy date.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Measured outcomes with their survey round attached?

A. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. B. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. C. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. D. The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence?

A. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. B. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. C. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. D. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.

Answer: A. Explanation: Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence?

A. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. B. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. C. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings,

which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Answer: B. Explanation: Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence?

A. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. D. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

Answer: C. Explanation: Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The measurement debate behind the poverty-hunger divergence?

A. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. B. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. D. Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.

Answer: D. Explanation: Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies The intervention bank for breaking the cycle?

A. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. B. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. C. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its

issuing body, survey round or policy date. D. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under The intervention bank for breaking the cycle?

A. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. B. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. C. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. D. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The intervention bank for breaking the cycle?

A. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. B. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. C. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. D. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The intervention bank for breaking the cycle?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. C. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and

pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership?

A. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. B. This topic owns the food and nutrition half of the capability argument, namely the statutory foodgrain entitlement, the nutrition services that sit on top of it, portability for mobile beneficiaries and the anthropometric outcomes by which the whole architecture is judged, and its distinctive feature is a dense direct-question record: three General Studies Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to it in the audited ledgers; the macro mechanics of procurement, buffer stocks and poverty measurement belong to the Economy owner, while this topic argues entitlement, access and conversion. C. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. D. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

Answer: A. Explanation: Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership?

A. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. B. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. C. The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. D. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: B. Explanation: Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership?

A. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. B. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as

interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. D. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

Answer: C. Explanation: Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Inclusion, exclusion and honest question ownership?

A. The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. B. Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. The Act itself fixes Central Issue Prices as a statutory ceiling of three rupees per kilogram for rice, two rupees per kilogram for wheat and one rupee per kilogram for coarse grains, but since 1 January 2023 the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana has been merged with the National Food Security Act and all Act foodgrains are distributed free of cost to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and priority-household beneficiaries, a policy the Union Cabinet extended for five years through December 2028; the discipline this demands is exact, because the statutory ceiling and the current distribution policy are two different facts and stating the ceiling as the price actually paid is the single commonest error in this topic. D. Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for

migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.

Answer: D. Explanation: Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Three General Studies Mains demands and two objective demands are routed to this topic in the audited routing ledgers, and each Mains demand is reproduced below as a demand card with its printed year, paper, question number, directive, marks and word limit exactly as the ledgers record them: 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 17, 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 7 and 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 7. Two objective demands are also routed, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I Question 25 on the beneficiary categories and provisions of the National Food Security Act, 2013 and 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I Question 52 on the interventions and target groups of the Anaemia Mukt Bharat strategy; the audited ledger records that the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, so no option, key or inferred answer is recorded for either objective demand and neither is converted into a solved question. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of the routed Mains demands; no question was invented from them and no marking scheme or page precision was imported. Every model solution below is original work written to the repository's examiner-grade standard using the claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification pattern.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Analytical body:

- Claim and named evidence:** Define the vulnerable group, deprivation, right or policy concept and distinguish the nearest legal and measured category. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, judicial or executive basis and the competent Union, state or local institution. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Map rights-holder, household/community context, duty-bearer, frontline worker, provider and accountability forum. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace identification, eligibility, documentation, finance, access, portability, grievance, appeal and correction. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named Indian law, judgment, scheme, institution or official dataset with source, date, denominator and status. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test intersectionality, regional variation, stigma, accessibility, privacy, fiscal adequacy, exclusion and causal limits. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2024 Q7 (10 marks):** Structure the answer as:

1. Define the vicious cycle (poverty -> undernutrition -> impaired development -> low productivity -> poverty).

2. Identify the intergenerational trap (stunted child -> lower-earning adult -> malnourished offspring).

3. List breaking-the-cycle levers: (a) Poshan 2.0 / first-1000-days focus, (b) PM POSHAN for school-age nutrition, (c) ONORC portability for migrants, (d) women's nutrition and anaemia reduction (adolescent girls, PLW), (e) WASH convergence (sanitation-nutrition link).

4. Conclude with the multi-sectoral, convergence imperative.

- FACT: **2025 GS-II Q16 (15 marks, 250 words):** "Inequality in the ownership pattern of

resources is one of the major causes of poverty. Discuss in the context of 'paradox of poverty'." Use the loop: unequal land/assets/credit/digital access -> unequal opportunity and bargaining power -> low capability/income -> weak saving and asset formation -> inherited inequality. A critical-comment answer should test this explanation against joblessness, unequal public-service access and implementation failures, then distinguish redistribution of productive assets from consumption relief.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-II	7	Poverty-malnutrition vicious cycle and human-capital formation	Explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Poverty-malnutrition vicious cycle and human-capital formation

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	17	Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger	How far do you agree · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	Prelims GS-I	25	National Food Security Act 2013 beneficiary categories and provisions	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	GS-II	7	Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure	Elucidate · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	Prelims GS-I	52	Anaemia Mukt Bharat Strategy interventions and target groups	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger
- National Food Security Act 2013 beneficiary categories and provisions
- Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure
- Anaemia Mukht Bharat Strategy interventions and target groups

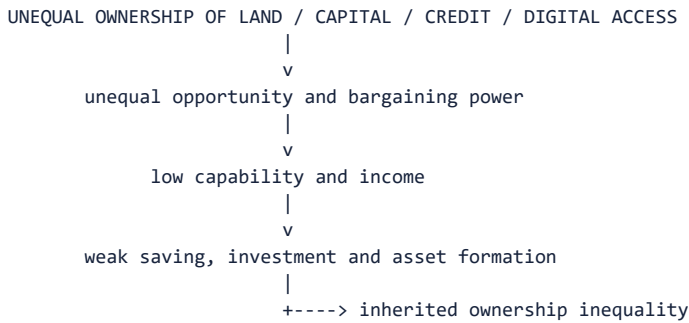
The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

3. Detailed causal chain: the intergenerational trap (2024 PYQ Q7)

1. **Poverty** limits household capacity to purchase diverse, nutrient-dense food and invest in health/sanitation.
2. **Food insecurity** manifests as calorie deficit (hunger) and dietary monotony (lack of micronutrients).
3. **Undernutrition in early childhood** (especially first 1000 days) causes stunting (chronic) and wasting (acute), impairs cognitive development and weakens immunity.
4. **Impaired development** reduces school attendance, learning outcomes and skill acquisition.
5. **Low human capital** translates into low productivity and earnings in adulthood.
6. **Low earnings** perpetuate household poverty, which is then transmitted to the next generation (intergenerational trap).
7. **Breaking-the-cycle levers:**
 - Nutrition-specific: Poshan 2.0 (first-1000-days focus), PM POSHAN (school-age), micronutrient supplementation (IFA tablets).
 - Nutrition-sensitive: WASH convergence (SBM, JJM), income support (DBT, social security), agricultural diversification.
 - Portability: ONORC for migrant-worker inclusion.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **FACT: 2024 Q7 (10 marks):** A strong answer should:
 1. Diagram the vicious cycle (poverty -> undernutrition -> impaired development -> low productivity -> poverty).
 2. Distinguish nutrition-specific (Poshan 2.0, PM POSHAN, micronutrient supplementation) from nutrition-sensitive (WASH, income support, agriculture) interventions.
 3. Emphasise the first-1000-days window and women's nutrition (anaemia in adolescent girls and PLW).
 4. Cite ONORC portability for migrant inclusion.
 5. Conclude with the convergence imperative: no single scheme breaks the cycle.
- **FACT: 2025 GS-II Q16 (15 marks, 250 words):** Build the "paradox of poverty" as a self-reinforcing asset-capability loop:



Separate productive-asset reform (land records/tenancy security, credit, skills, commons and digital access) from necessary but non-transformative consumption relief.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	17	Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger	How far do you agree · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	GS-II	7	Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure	Elucidate · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Food availability focus against human development policies as cause of hunger
- Divergence between poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 17

Demand: How far do you agree that a focus on the availability of food rather than on human development policies is the cause of hunger in India, 15 marks, 250 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the availability argument is partly right and structurally incomplete, because availability is only the first of four stages and hunger in India is produced mainly at the access and absorption stages. Named evidence and example: the statutory entitlement of five kilograms per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households under the National Food Security Act, 2013, with the Department of Food and Public Distribution portal read on 2 September 2026 recording enactment on 5 July 2013, coverage of up to seventy-five per cent of the rural and fifty per cent of the urban population and a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons; the Act's life-cycle provisions and the maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees; the distinction between nutrition-specific and nutrition-sensitive interventions; and the National

Family Health Survey record of under-five stunting at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24 released on 29 May 2026. Analysis: an availability-first reading explains procurement and buffer policy but cannot explain why a household holding a valid card remains undernourished, since access fails through identification, documentation and migration barriers, and absorption fails through diarrhoeal disease, unsafe water and poor sanitation, which is precisely why the reduction in stunting between two named rounds cannot be credited to grain allocation alone. Qualification: the human-development reading must not be pushed into denying that availability matters, because a chronic supply failure would make every downstream policy irrelevant, and each indicator must be carried with its survey round. Why this earns marks: it takes a position on a how-far-do-you-agree directive, uses the four-stage frame as the organising device and closes with a bounded verdict.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 17”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the availability argument is partly right and structurally incomplete, because availability is only the first of four stages and hunger in India is produced mainly at the access and absorption stages. Named evidence and example: the statutory entitlement of five kilograms per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households under the National Food Security Act, 2013, with the Department of Food and Public Distribution portal read on 2 September 2026 recording enactment on 5 July 2013, coverage of up to seventy-five per cent of the rural and fifty per cent of the urban population and a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons; the Act's life-cycle provisions and the maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees; the distinction between nutrition-specific and nutrition-sensitive interventions; and the National Family Health Survey record of under-five stunting at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24 released on 29 May 2026. Analysis: an availability-first reading explains procurement and buffer policy but cannot explain why a household holding a valid card remains undernourished, since access fails through identification, documentation and migration barriers, and absorption fails through diarrhoeal disease, unsafe water and poor sanitation, which is precisely why the reduction in stunting between two named rounds cannot be credited to grain allocation alone. Qualification: the human-development reading must not be pushed into denying that availability matters, because a chronic supply failure would make every downstream policy irrelevant, and each indicator must be carried with its survey round. Why this earns marks: it takes a position on a how-far-do-you-agree directive, uses the four-stage frame as the organising device and closes with a bounded verdict.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 17 **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the availability argument is partly right and structurally incomplete, because availability is only the first of four stages and hunger in India is produced mainly at the access and absorption stages. Named evidence and example: the statutory entitlement of five kilograms per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households under the National Food Security Act, 2013, with the Department of Food and Public Distribution portal read on 2 September 2026 recording enactment on 5 July 2013, coverage of up to seventy-five per cent of the rural and fifty per cent of the urban population and a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons; the Act's life-cycle provisions and the maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees; the distinction between nutrition-specific and nutrition-sensitive interventions; and the National Family Health Survey record of under-five stunting at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24 released on 29 May 2026. Analysis: an availability-first reading explains

procurement and buffer policy but cannot explain why a household holding a valid card remains undernourished, since access fails through identification, documentation and migration barriers, and absorption fails through diarrhoeal disease, unsafe water and poor sanitation, which is precisely why the reduction in stunting between two named rounds cannot be credited to grain allocation alone. Qualification: the human-development reading must not be pushed into denying that availability matters, because a chronic supply failure would make every downstream policy irrelevant, and each indicator must be carried with its survey round. Why this earns marks: it takes a position on a how-far-do-you-agree directive, uses the four-stage frame as the organising device and closes with a bounded verdict.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 17”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 7

Demand: Elucidate the relationship between the divergence of poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure, 10 marks, 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: poverty and hunger diverge because they are measured by different instruments and repaired by different expenditures, so a fall in one is not evidence of a fall in the other. Named evidence and example: the owner's rule that income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations; the four-stage availability, access, absorption and utilisation frame; the anganwadi service layer under Poshan 2.0 with the Ministry of Women and Child Development and the school layer under PM POSHAN with the Ministry of Education; and the first thousand days from conception to age two as the window in which deprivation becomes irreversible. Analysis: monetary poverty responds to income, transfer and employment expenditure, whereas hunger and undernutrition respond to service expenditure on anganwadi staffing, growth monitoring, therapeutic care, water and sanitation, so compressing the service head while transfers hold produces exactly the observed divergence, and because the critical window is short, a service compression today is recorded in the anthropometry of the next decade. Qualification: no expenditure figure or trend is asserted here, since budget numbers must be cited with their year and head, and the divergence claim itself must be carried with the survey rounds compared. Why this earns marks: it elucidates a mechanism connecting two measurements to two expenditure heads instead of describing poverty in general.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 7”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: poverty and hunger diverge because they are measured by different instruments and repaired by different expenditures, so a fall in one is not evidence of a fall in the other. Named evidence and example: the owner's rule that income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations; the four-stage availability, access, absorption and utilisation frame; the anganwadi service layer under Poshan 2.0 with the Ministry of Women and Child Development and the school layer under PM POSHAN with the Ministry of Education; and the first thousand days from conception to age two as the window in which deprivation becomes irreversible. Analysis: monetary poverty responds to income, transfer and employment expenditure, whereas hunger and undernutrition respond to service expenditure on anganwadi staffing, growth monitoring, therapeutic care, water and sanitation, so compressing the service head while transfers hold produces exactly the observed divergence, and because the critical window is short, a service compression today is recorded in the anthropometry of the next decade. Qualification: no expenditure figure or trend is asserted here, since budget numbers must be cited with their year and head, and the divergence claim itself must be carried with the survey rounds compared. Why this earns

marks: it elucidates a mechanism connecting two measurements to two expenditure heads instead of describing poverty in general.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 7 **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Elucidate the relationship between the divergence of poverty and hunger and shrinking social expenditure, 10 marks, 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: poverty and hunger diverge because they are measured by different instruments and repaired by different expenditures, so a fall in one is not evidence of a fall in the other. Named evidence and example: the owner's rule that income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations; the four-stage availability, access, absorption and utilisation frame; the anganwadi service layer under Poshan 2.0 with the Ministry of Women and Child Development and the school layer under PM POSHAN with the Ministry of Education; and the first thousand days from conception to age two as the window in which deprivation becomes irreversible. Analysis: monetary poverty responds to income, transfer and employment expenditure, whereas hunger and undernutrition respond to service expenditure on anganwadi staffing, growth monitoring, therapeutic care, water and sanitation, so compressing the service head while transfers hold produces exactly the observed divergence, and because the critical window is short, a service compression today is recorded in the anthropometry of the next decade. Qualification: no expenditure figure or trend is asserted here, since budget numbers must be cited with their year and head, and the divergence claim itself must be carried with the survey rounds compared. Why this earns marks: it elucidates a mechanism connecting two measurements to two expenditure heads instead of describing poverty in general.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 7", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 7

Demand: Poverty and malnutrition create a vicious cycle, adversely affecting human capital formation. What steps can be taken to break the cycle, explain, 10 marks, 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and reproduced in the Basic owner.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the cycle is intergenerational, so it is broken only at the points where deprivation becomes irreversible and where entitlement fails to travel with the person. Named evidence and example: the loop from income and asset deprivation through calorie and micronutrient deficit to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, low human capital and low earnings; the first thousand days from conception to age two; Poshan 2.0

and the anganwadi layer under the Ministry of Women and Child Development; PM POSHAN in Classes I to VIII under the Ministry of Education; One Nation One Ration Card portability using Aadhaar-seeded cards and electronic point-of-sale machines; and the national anaemia strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design for adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women. Analysis: the first thousand days fix the sequencing, because a stunted child becomes a lower-earning adult whose child is again undernourished, so maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments rather than separate heads; portability addresses the exclusion produced by migration; and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene addresses absorption, which no additional grain allocation can reach. Qualification: acute malnutrition is not answered by extra grain, since severe acute malnutrition at weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations requires facility-based therapeutic care, and every outcome cited must carry its survey round, with under-five stunting recorded at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24. Why this earns marks: it explains a loop, attaches each lever to the exact link it cuts and ends with a treatment and data qualification.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 7”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the cycle is intergenerational, so it is broken only at the points where deprivation becomes irreversible and where entitlement fails to travel with the person. Named evidence and example: the loop from income and asset deprivation through calorie and micronutrient deficit to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, low human capital and low earnings; the first thousand days from conception to age two; Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi layer under the Ministry of Women and Child Development; PM POSHAN in Classes I to VIII under the Ministry of Education; One Nation One Ration Card portability using Aadhaar-seeded cards and electronic point-of-sale machines; and the national anaemia strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design for adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women. Analysis: the first thousand days fix the sequencing, because a stunted child becomes a lower-earning adult whose child is again undernourished, so maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments rather than separate heads; portability addresses the exclusion produced by migration; and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene addresses absorption, which no additional grain allocation can reach. Qualification: acute malnutrition is not answered by extra grain, since severe acute malnutrition at weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations requires facility-based therapeutic care, and every outcome cited must carry its survey round, with under-five stunting recorded at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24. Why this earns marks: it explains a loop, attaches each lever to the exact link it cuts and ends with a treatment and data qualification.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 7 **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the cycle is intergenerational, so it is broken only at the points where deprivation becomes irreversible and where entitlement fails to travel with the person. Named evidence and example: the loop from income and asset deprivation through calorie and micronutrient deficit to impaired cognitive, physical and

immune development, low human capital and low earnings; the first thousand days from conception to age two; Poshan 2.0 and the anganwadi layer under the Ministry of Women and Child Development; PM POSHAN in Classes I to VIII under the Ministry of Education; One Nation One Ration Card portability using Aadhaar-seeded cards and electronic point-of-sale machines; and the national anaemia strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design for adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women. Analysis: the first thousand days fix the sequencing, because a stunted child becomes a lower-earning adult whose child is again undernourished, so maternal and adolescent nutrition are child-nutrition instruments rather than separate heads; portability addresses the exclusion produced by migration; and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene addresses absorption, which no additional grain allocation can reach. Qualification: acute malnutrition is not answered by extra grain, since severe acute malnutrition at weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations requires facility-based therapeutic care, and every outcome cited must carry its survey round, with under-five stunting recorded at 35.5 per cent in the fifth round of 2019-21 and 29.3 per cent in the sixth round of 2023-24. Why this earns marks: it explains a loop, attaches each lever to the exact link it cuts and ends with a treatment and data qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 7”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain how poverty and malnutrition reinforce each other and identify the interventions that can break the cycle. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The loop is intergenerational and multi-causal, so the answer must trace deprivation through undernutrition, impaired development and low human capital back to low earnings, then attach named multi-sectoral levers rather than a single-scheme remedy.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for.
- The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.
- The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.
- Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public

distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.

Qualified conclusion: The loop is intergenerational and multi-causal, so the answer must trace deprivation through undernutrition, impaired development and low human capital back to low earnings, then attach named multi-sectoral levers rather than a single-scheme remedy.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Explain how poverty and malnutrition reinforce each other and identify the interventions that...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The loop is intergenerational and multi-causal, so the answer must trace deprivation through undernutrition, impaired development and low human capital back to low earnings, then attach named multi-sectoral levers rather than a single-scheme remedy.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The cycle recorded in the owner runs from income and asset deprivation to food insecurity, from food insecurity to undernutrition in the form of both calorie deficit and protein and micronutrient deficit, from undernutrition to impaired cognitive, physical and immune development, from impaired development to low human-capital formation in schooling attainment and productivity, and from low productivity back to low earnings, which reproduces the deprivation in the next generation; naming the loop and the point of intergenerational transmission is what converts a scheme list into the explanation that the 2024 demand asks for. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukt Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status,

denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The loop is intergenerational and multi-causal, so the answer must trace deprivation through undernutrition, impaired development and low human capital back to low earnings, then attach named multi-sectoral levers rather than a single-scheme remedy.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain how poverty and malnutrition reinforce each other and identify the interventions that...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Elucidate why measured poverty and measured hunger can move in different directions. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Different instruments measure different deprivations, so the answer must separate monetary poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry, then separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation to locate where the divergence is produced.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach.
- Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.
- Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one.
- The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that

indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round.

Qualified conclusion: Different instruments measure different deprivations, so the answer must separate monetary poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry, then separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation to locate where the divergence is produced.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Elucidate why measured poverty and measured hunger can move in different directions. Answer...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Different instruments measure different deprivations, so the answer must separate monetary poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry, then separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation to locate where the divergence is produced.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Income or calorie poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry measure different deprivations, so falling monetary poverty can coexist with continuing hunger and undernutrition, and this divergence is the analytical core of the demand that asks about poverty and hunger moving apart alongside shrinking social expenditure; the answer route is to separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation, because availability failures are procurement problems, access failures are entitlement and portability problems, and absorption failures are health, sanitation and disease problems that no grain allocation can reach. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Stunting is low height-for-age in children under five and reflects cumulative chronic nutritional and health deprivation, especially in the first thousand days, wasting is low weight-for-height in children under five and reflects recent or acute food shortage or illness and is therefore a crisis indicator, and anaemia is a haemoglobin deficiency arising from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall that reduces oxygen-carrying capacity and is prevalent among children, adolescent girls and pregnant women; the three call for different policy responses, so treating them as interchangeable is a factual error rather than a stylistic one. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the National Family Health Survey as the primary survey source for stunting, wasting, anaemia and related household outcomes and require the round to be retained beside every value: the fifth round of 2019-21 is recorded as the dated baseline with 35.5 per cent of children under five stunted, 19.3 per cent wasted and 67.1 per cent of children aged six to fifty-nine months anaemic nationally, and the sixth round of 2023-24, released on 29 May 2026, is recorded as the current national round with under-five stunting reported at 29.3 per cent, a survey covering 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households; the rule stated by the owners is that indicators from the two rounds must never be combined without naming each round. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy,

portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Different instruments measure different deprivations, so the answer must separate monetary poverty, multidimensional poverty and anthropometry, then separate availability, access, absorption and utilisation to locate where the divergence is produced.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Elucidate why measured poverty and measured hunger can move in different directions. Answer...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess whether India's food-security architecture has converted a discretionary scheme into an enforceable entitlement. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The statutory shift is real and is evidenced by the entitlement quantities, the life-cycle provisions and the food security allowance, but coverage identification, portability gaps and absorption failures limit it, so the assessment must be graded and must name the tier at which the claim fails.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.
- The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards.
- The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion.

- The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

Qualified conclusion: The statutory shift is real and is evidenced by the entitlement quantities, the life-cycle provisions and the food security allowance, but coverage identification, portability gaps and absorption failures limit it, so the assessment must be graded and must name the tier at which the claim fails.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess whether India's food-security architecture has converted a discretionary scheme into...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The statutory shift is real and is evidenced by the entitlement quantities, the life-cycle provisions and the food security allowance, but coverage identification, portability gaps and absorption failures limit it, so the assessment must be graded and must name the tier at which the claim fails.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Department of Food and Public Distribution's portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that a guiding principle of the Act is its life-cycle approach, under which special provisions entitle pregnant women, lactating mothers and children from six months to fourteen years to receive a nutritious meal free of cost through the anganwadi network under the Integrated Child Development Services scheme and through schools under the mid-day meal scheme, that higher nutritional norms are prescribed for malnourished children up to six years of age, and that pregnant women and lactating mothers are entitled to cash maternity benefit of not less than six thousand rupees to partly compensate wage loss and supplement nutrition; the same source records that the eldest woman of the household aged eighteen or above is mandated to be the head of the household for the purpose of issuing ration cards. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The same official portal records that where entitled quantities of foodgrains or meals are not supplied, the entitled person is entitled to receive a food security allowance from the concerned State Government, payable to each person within the time and manner prescribed by the Central Government, and that these provisions are governed through the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015; this is the clause that makes the entitlement a rights-based claim rather than a discretionary scheme, and citing it by name is what allows an answer to argue the charity-to-claim shift with evidence instead of assertion. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative

status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.

Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The statutory shift is real and is evidenced by the entitlement quantities, the life-cycle provisions and the food security allowance, but coverage identification, portability gaps and absorption failures limit it, so the assessment must be graded and must name the tier at which the claim fails.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess whether India's food-security architecture has converted a discretionary scheme into...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the claim that a focus on food availability rather than on human-development policy is the principal cause of hunger in India. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Availability is only the first of four stages, so the examination must test the claim against access, absorption and utilisation, concede what the availability argument does explain, and end by naming the conversion failures that grain allocation cannot reach.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one.
- Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.
- The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One

Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment.

- Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

Qualified conclusion: Availability is only the first of four stages, so the examination must test the claim against access, absorption and utilisation, concede what the availability argument does explain, and end by naming the conversion failures that grain allocation cannot reach.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the claim that a focus on food availability rather than on human-development policy...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Availability is only the first of four stages, so the examination must test the claim against access, absorption and utilisation, concede what the availability argument does explain, and end by naming the conversion failures that grain allocation cannot reach.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner's breaking-the-cycle levers are the first-thousand-days focus delivered through the nutrition mission and the anganwadi system, school nutrition through PM POSHAN, portability for migrants through One Nation One Ration Card, women's nutrition and anaemia reduction aimed at adolescent girls and pregnant and lactating women through the Anaemia Mukh Bharat strategy with its six-by-six-by-six design, and convergence with water, sanitation and hygiene because sanitation and safe water govern nutrient absorption; the owner also records that fortification can address selected micronutrient gaps at scale but cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or clinical treatment. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Availability is only the first of four stages, so the examination must test the claim against access, absorption and utilisation, concede what the availability argument does explain, and end by naming the conversion failures that grain allocation cannot reach.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the claim that a focus on food availability rather than on human-development policy...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the design of India's nutrition delivery system across the life cycle and the trade-offs it embodies. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The system layers a statutory grain entitlement, an anganwadi service layer and a school-meal layer across different ages and ministries, so the assessment must test each layer against the outcome it claims, name the ration-format and ministry trade-offs, and close with a graded verdict.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two.
- PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates.
- A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires

kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it.

- Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it.

Qualified conclusion: The system layers a statutory grain entitlement, an anganwadi service layer and a school-meal layer across different ages and ministries, so the assessment must test each layer against the outcome it claims, name the ration-format and ministry trade-offs, and close with a graded verdict.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the design of India's nutrition delivery system across the life cycle and the trade-...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The system layers a statutory grain entitlement, an anganwadi service layer and a school-meal layer across different ages and ministries, so the assessment must test each layer against the outcome it claims, name the ration-format and ministry trade-offs, and close with a graded verdict.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Poshan 2.0, also carried as Saksham Anganwadi, is the umbrella nutrition programme administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development that merges the Integrated Child Development Services and related schemes and delivers supplementary nutrition as take-home ration and hot cooked meals, growth monitoring through weight and height tracking, pre-school education, immunisation referral and health and nutrition counselling through anganwadi centres, with its primary focus on children under six and on pregnant and lactating women and an explicit emphasis on the first thousand days from conception to age two. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** PM POSHAN, the erstwhile mid-day meal programme, is administered by the Ministry of Education and implemented through State education departments and school management committees, providing a cooked meal to children in government and government-aided schools in Classes I to VIII with the stated objectives of attendance, retention and improved nutritional status; the ministry pairing is a standing objective-question trap, because Poshan 2.0 sits with the Ministry of Women and Child Development while PM POSHAN sits with the Ministry of Education, and the two are complementary layers for different age groups rather than duplicates. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A take-home ration is a dry ration given to the beneficiary to cook at home and is used for pregnant and lactating women and for children between six months and three years, whereas a hot cooked meal is served at the anganwadi centre or the school, so the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery but requires kitchen and staffing infrastructure, while the take-home ration is more flexible and may be redistributed within the household; naming this trade-off is how an answer explains a delivery design choice rather than merely listing it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Severe acute malnutrition is defined by weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations, is severe wasting and requires facility-based therapeutic care at a nutrition rehabilitation

centre, whereas moderate acute malnutrition lies between minus two and minus three standard deviations and can be managed through community-based supplementary feeding, and both are tracked through anganwadi growth monitoring; the examinable point is that acute malnutrition needs screening, referral, treatment where indicated and community follow-up, so an additional foodgrain allocation is not a response to it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The system layers a statutory grain entitlement, an anganwadi service layer and a school-meal layer across different ages and ministries, so the assessment must test each layer against the outcome it claims, name the ration-format and ministry trade-offs, and close with a graded verdict.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the design of India's nutrition delivery system across the life cycle and the trade-...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess whether portability and identification reform have reduced exclusion from India's food entitlement. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Portability addresses one exclusion mechanism while identification reform can generate another, so the assessment must separate inclusion from exclusion error, use the official identification process as evidence, and end with a verdict that carries a stated data limit.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability.
- Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date.
- The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana

households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal, read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion.

- The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general.

Qualified conclusion: Portability addresses one exclusion mechanism while identification reform can generate another, so the assessment must separate inclusion from exclusion error, use the official identification process as evidence, and end with a verdict that carries a stated data limit.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess whether portability and identification reform have reduced exclusion from India's food...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Portability addresses one exclusion mechanism while identification reform can generate another, so the assessment must separate inclusion from exclusion error, use the official identification process as evidence, and end with a verdict that carries a stated data limit.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** One Nation One Ration Card enables portability of the Act's entitlements across States using Aadhaar-seeded ration cards and electronic point-of-sale machines at fair-price shops, with the technical backbone provided through the national informatics and food-corporation systems, and it is the instrument that addresses the exclusion of migrant and mobile beneficiaries from State-specific lists; it is not a separate ration card and not a separate entitlement but a system interoperability feature, and the owners record that its cumulative transaction count on the integrated management portal rises continuously and is therefore not fixed here, the durable fact being operational inter-State portability. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Inclusion error places non-eligible persons on distribution lists while exclusion error keeps eligible persons off them, most often through documentation, seeding, migration and disability-related barriers, and the owners record that portability and deduplication aim at both while exclusion risk for migrants and marginalised groups persists, which is why the official portal's description of identification as a continuous process of removing ineligible, fake and duplicate cards and adding births and genuine left-out households is itself examinable. On ownership, three Mains demands from 2018, 2019 and 2024 and two objective demands from 2018 and 2023 are routed to this topic in the audited ledgers, the official answer keys for those objective demands are recorded by the ledgers as unavailable locally, so no option is inferred or recorded, and no poverty, nutrition or coverage figure is asserted anywhere in this package without its issuing body, survey round or policy date. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory entitlement of five kilograms of foodgrain per person per month for priority households and thirty-five kilograms per household per month for Antyodaya Anna Yojana households, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution's own portal,

read on 2 September 2026, records that the Act was enacted on 5 July 2013, that it marks a paradigm shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach, that it legally entitles up to seventy-five per cent of the rural population and fifty per cent of the urban population to receive subsidised foodgrains under the targeted public distribution system, that it is implemented in all States and Union Territories, and that out of a maximum coverage of 81.34 crore persons around 80 crore persons are covered at present, with identification treated as a continuous process of exclusion and inclusion. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The official portal records that the Act defines a joint responsibility, under which the Centre allocates the required foodgrains to States and Union Territories, transports them up to designated depots in each State and Union Territory and provides central assistance for delivery from designated Food Corporation of India godowns to the doorstep of the fair-price shop, while States and Union Territories are responsible for effective implementation, which includes identifying eligible households, issuing ration cards and distributing the foodgrain entitlement; this division is the reason why a delivery failure must be attributed to a named tier rather than to the government in general. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.

Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Portability addresses one exclusion mechanism while identification reform can generate another, so the assessment must separate inclusion from exclusion error, use the official identification process as evidence, and end with a verdict that carries a stated data limit.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess whether portability and identification reform have reduced exclusion from India's food...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.